SYSTEM + COMPONENT LEGEND

Architecture reference for rebuilding with canonical Illustrator assets

PAGE SYSTEM

The marks below are placeholders, not final artwork

A — **DISPLAY HEADING**
Replace with existing custom display-type asset/style.

B — **METADATA FIELD**
Compact record identity, title, date, instrument and cross-references.

C6 / C7 — **TAB SYSTEM**
Use exactly six or seven strings; TAB remains relative to tuning/capo.

D6 / D7 — **PRIMARY POSITION**
Use canonical diamond diagrams; label names are always optional.

E6 / E7 — **FRETBOARD TAXONOMY**
Instrument-correct long fretboard diagram.

F — **SETUP BLOCK**
Tuning, capo configuration, tonal home, tempo and feel.

G — **REFERENCE LINK**
T-###, C-###, M-### and optional P-### relational fields.

H — **FREEFORM ZONE**
Piece maps, notes and annotations without heavy boxes.

RECORD RELATIONSHIPS

Paper fields should map cleanly to a future digital system

Cross-reference rather than duplicate durable musical ideas

PRODUCTION RULES

Constraints for the Illustrator master

- 0.50 in live margin; no essential content outside it.
- Black/white print master first; muted color may be a separate digital layer.
- Use boxes only for meaningful containers; retain generous negative space.
- Keep headings, rules, TAB, diagrams, labels and annotations on separate layers.
- Do not outline text until typography and naming are approved.
- Preserve every final component as reusable vector artwork or symbol.

6-STRING COMPOSITION RECORD

Master overview record; use continuation sheets for extended transcription

COMPOSITION ID C-____ WORKING TITLE _____ DATE _____ GUITAR / INSTRUMENT _____

SETUP

F / tuning + capo + tonal information

TUNING / HIGH TO LOW

S1 _____ S2 _____ S3 _____ S4 _____ S5 _____ S6 _____

CAPO

☐ NONE ☐ FULL FRET _____

PARTIAL STRINGS 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6 ☐

TONAL CENTER / HOME _____ DRONE / HOME POSITION _____ TEMPO _____ FEEL _____

PRIMARY POSITIONS

D6 / 8 canonical diamond diagrams

PIECE MAP

H / freeform sequence, section names and motif references

INTRO -> A -> M-___ -> B -> A' -> OUT

Example only. Leave the production version empty.

CORE MATERIAL

C6 / abbreviated TAB only; reference M-### when an idea deserves its own record

SECTION / MOTIF ID _____ ROLE / NOTE _____

T
A
B

SECTION / MOTIF ID _____ ROLE / NOTE _____

T
A
B

REFERENCES + NOTES

G / associated tuning, motifs, continuation pages and observations

T-____ M-____ M-____ TAB CONT. ____ / ____

7-STRING COMPOSITION RECORD

Master overview record; use continuation sheets for extended transcription

COMPOSITION ID C-____ WORKING TITLE _____ DATE _____ GUITAR / INSTRUMENT _____

SETUP

F / tuning + capo + tonal information

TUNING / HIGH TO LOW

S1 _____ S2 _____ S3 _____ S4 _____ S5 _____ S6 _____ S7 _____

CAPO

☐ NONE ☐ FULL FRET _____

PARTIAL STRINGS

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6 ☐ 7 ☐

TONAL CENTER / HOME _____ DRONE / HOME POSITION _____ TEMPO _____ FEEL _____

PRIMARY POSITIONS

D7 / 8 canonical diamond diagrams

PIECE MAP

H / freeform sequence, section names and motif references

INTRO -> A -> M-___ -> B -> A' -> OUT

Example only. Leave the production version empty.

CORE MATERIAL

C7 / abbreviated TAB only; reference M-### when an idea deserves its own record

SECTION / MOTIF ID _____ ROLE / NOTE _____

T
A
B

SECTION / MOTIF ID _____ ROLE / NOTE _____

T
A
B

REFERENCES + NOTES

G / associated tuning, motifs, continuation pages and observations

T-____ M-____ M-____ TAB CONT. ____ / ____

TUNING RECORD

One durable record for what was discovered inside a tuning

TUNING ID T-____ NAME _____ DATE _____ INSTRUMENT / GUITAR _____

SETUP

F / seventh string is omitted when not applicable

TUNING / HIGH TO LOW

S1 ____ S2 ____ S3 ____ S4 ____ S5 ____ S6 ____ S7 ____

STRINGS ☐ 6 ☐ 7

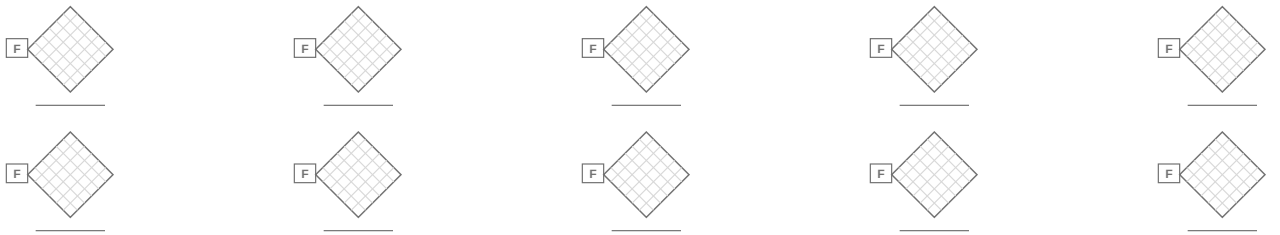
TONAL CHARACTER / HOME _____ DRONE / OPEN-STRING BEHAVIOR _____

CAPO ☐ NONE ☐ FULL FRET _____

PARTIAL STRINGS 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐

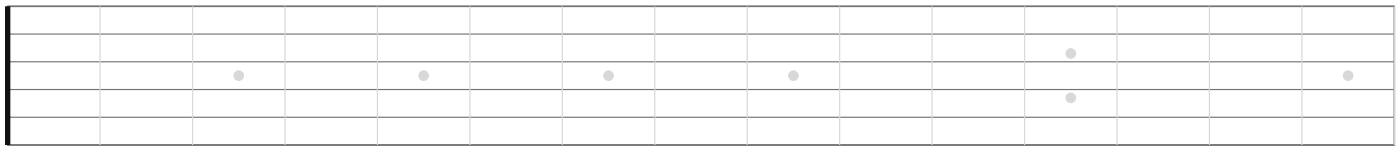
PRIMARY POSITIONS

D6 / D7 / ten canonical diamond diagrams



FRETBOARD TAXONOMY

E6 / E7 / map useful pitches, harmonics, intervals and movement



RELATIONSHIPS

G / link reusable ideas instead of rewriting them

ASSOCIATED MOTIFS

M-____ M-____ M-____

ASSOCIATED COMPOSITIONS

C-____ C-____ C-____

NOTES

H / technique, string gauges, tension, transposition, discoveries

MOTIF RECORD

One portable musical object per page; duplicate into 6- and 7-string final variants

MOTIF ID M-____ NAME / INFORMAL DESCRIPTION _____ DATE _____ SOURCE COMPOSITION C-____

CONTEXT

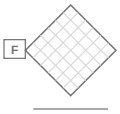
F + G / enough setup data to make the TAB meaningful years later

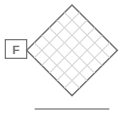
TUNING ID T-____ INSTRUMENT / GUITAR _____ TONAL / CHORD CONTEXT _____ FUNCTION / USE _____

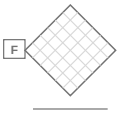
CAPO ☐ NONE ☐ FULL FRET _____ ☐ PARTIAL STRINGS ☐ 6 ☐ 7 INTRO / TRANSITION / OSTINATO / ENDING / TEXTURE

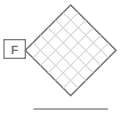
POSITION CONTEXT

D6 / D7 / up to four voicings or hand positions









PRIMARY TRANSCRIPTION

C6 / C7 / install instrument-correct TAB system in each final variant

TAB SYSTEM
C6 OR C7 / phrase 1

TAB SYSTEM
C6 OR C7 / phrase 2

TAB SYSTEM
C6 OR C7 / phrase 3

VARIATIONS

Record mutations without overwriting the original motif

VARIATION A / M-____a

TAB SYSTEM
C6 OR C7

VARIATION B / M-____b

TAB SYSTEM
C6 OR C7

RELATIONS + NOTES

G + H / related motifs, compositions, performance cues and memory triggers

RELATED M-____ M-____ COMPOSITIONS C-____ C-____